

significantly, in 1711 Estienne Roger, a Frenchman working in Amsterdam, published a collection of 12 of his concertos collectively entitled *L'estro armonico* (Harmonic Inspiration). Roger was the most important music publisher in Europe, partly because of the quality of his engraving and printing, but mainly because he had a highly efficient distribution network, with agents in Berlin, London, Paris, and other cities. He played a key role in securing Vivaldi's international reputation.

Vivaldi's own travels also helped spread his fame. His first opera was produced in Vicenza in 1713 and in 1718–1720 he lived in Mantua—a city subject to the Holy Roman Empire—where he wrote several works for the court of the music-loving governor, Prince Philip of Hesse-Darmstadt. In the early 1720s, he spent much of his time in Rome, where several of his operas were performed (he was the impresario as well as composer). From late 1729 to early 1731, he traveled in central Europe with his elderly father, visiting Vienna and perhaps also Prague.

Vivaldi's operas brought him into contact with an attractive young singer called Anna Girò (or Giraud), who regularly appeared in them, usually in a leading role, from 1726 to 1739. Although she was about 30 years younger than Vivaldi, there was gossip that they were lovers. The rumors were probably groundless, but they damaged Vivaldi's career. In particular, in 1738 the archbishop of Ferrara forbade him to enter the city and this led to canceled performances of his operas there.